INSTAGRAM SETUP CHECKLIST

About 30 minutes, once. It protects everything you post afterward. Chapters 7 and 16 of the playbook explain why each step matters.

1. ACCOUNT TYPE

- [ ] **Switch to a professional account** if you haven't: Profile → menu (the three lines) → Account type and tools → Switch to professional account → pick a category.
- [ ] **Creator or Business?** Choose **Business** if you need product tags or a shop, lead forms, an address on your profile, or a tool that requires Business. Otherwise choose **Creator**. Neither gets more reach, and neither gives you music rights.

2. FOUR SETTINGS THAT MATTER

- [ ] **Keep the account public.** Private accounts can't be recommended to new people.
- [ ] **Check Account Status** (in Settings). It shows whether your account can be recommended to people who don't follow you, and what to fix if not. Check again if your reach suddenly collapses.
- [ ] **Allow search engines:** leave "Allow public photos and videos to appear in search engine results" on.
- [ ] **Connect Facebook sharing** (section 4).

3. YOUR PROFILE IS YOUR BUYING HUB

- [ ] **Name field** says what you do: "Frank | Handyman in Austin."
- [ ] **Bio** passes the 10-second test: what you sell, who it's for, the price or "from $__," and what to do next.
- [ ] **First link** goes straight to your one next step (a product, booking, quote, or checkout page, never a generic homepage).
- [ ] **Action button** (if your booking tool supports one), **3 pinned posts** (best proof, clearest offer explainer, most-asked question), and **Highlights**: "How to buy," "Reviews," "FAQ."

4. FACEBOOK: SET IT ONCE (5 MINUTES)

- [ ] Instagram → Profile → menu (the three lines) → **Accounts Center → Connected experiences → Sharing across profiles**.
- [ ] Choose your Instagram account as the source and your **Facebook Page** as the destination.
- [ ] Turn on automatic sharing for **posts** and **Reels**. Stories are optional: check how yours look on Facebook first.
- [ ] Confirm your Facebook Reels audience is **Public** (in Facebook's Reels settings).
- [ ] After your first few Reels, look at them on Facebook: video, audio and caption. If a Reel's music didn't carry over, reshare it with original or cleared audio.

5. BEFORE YOU POST ANYTHING

- [ ] A folder outside Instagram (Google Drive, Dropbox, or iCloud) for clean master files, carousel source files, photos, hooks that worked, and proof screenshots (with permission).
- [ ] Your one next step and its exact link, written down.
- [ ] The phone test done: open your profile as a customer, tap your link, try to buy, book, or request a quote, and fix the first friction point.
- [ ] Insights location found: Profile → Professional dashboard (account-wide), and "View insights" under any post.

Menu names change. Instagram moves and renames settings from time to time, and they can differ between iPhone and Android. If a step doesn't match your app, search for the setting's name in Settings.